



Mens AG4 Athlete Programme
5 x Per Week

Welcome To The Athlete Programme 5x A Week

If you wish to go to the gym 5 times a week, have been training for a while, and want to take your body to an elite level, I suggest you try out this programme! It will teach you how to train to an advanced level, and you will learn what your body is capable of, and when to give yourself a rest.

Use the advanced programme to push yourself, and find your limits.

This Is A Challenging Programme

Aim for 70 - 80% adherence to this programme. This means you can reduce the number of sets, miss cardio here and there, and swap out certain styles of cardio for easier ones depending on how you feel. At this stage listening to your body is important. IF you feel tired, if you feel injuries start to build, you have to use your intuition when training at an advanced level.

This is an elite programme, if you follow it even 70 - 80% you will see some of the most progress you have ever seen. This is a challenging programme and what we are setting you is the "ideal" week, which you then regulate based on what you can manage. Don't worry if you don't stick to it 100% all the time, there is some flexibility here with such an advanced level programme.





Advanced AG4 Program — 5 Days Per Week (Male)

Push/Pull/Legs · 2-Fortnight Cycle

WEEK 1							
	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION	AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy	AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy	AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day	REST	AG4 Push Day 2 — Power	AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power	REST
WARM UP	AG Push Day Warm Up	AG Pull Day Warm Up	AG Leg Day Warm Up	REST	1,000 Steps Stair Climber or Jog	AG Pull Day Warm Up	REST
ABS	Select from Abs Library	Back Extension — 3 × failure	Select from Abs Library	REST	Select from Abs Library	Back Extension — 3 × failure	REST
CARDIO	Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	REST	AG Power Cardio	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	REST

WEEK 2 — THEN REPEAT FROM WEEK 1							
	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION	AG4 Push Day 3 — Speed	AG Pull Day 3 — Biceps Focus	AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day	REST	AG4 Push Day 2 — Power	AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power	REST
WARM UP	AG Push Day Warm Up	AG Pull Day Warm Up	AG Leg Day Warm Up	REST	1,000 Steps Stair Climber or Jog	AG Pull Day Warm Up	REST
ABS	Decline Sit Ups 2×fail Ab Roller 3×fail Speed Sit Ups 4×fail	Back Extension — 3 × failure	Select from Abs Library	REST	Select from Abs Library	Back Extension — 3 × failure	REST
CARDIO	AG Speed Cardio — sprints / speed movements	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	REST	AG Power Cardio	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	REST

* At the advanced level, apply 3–5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

Don't be intimidated by the programme card! It is essentially the same as the previous stages of AG4. The only changes are: we now operate on a 2-week system with athletic Power days and Speed days rotated in. You will do a Speed Day and a Biceps-focused Pull Day once every second week.

Warm ups, the types of cardio, and the abs library will be explained in later pages.
For now take a look at the timetable and visualise the programme.



Advanced AG4 Program — 6 Days Per Week (Male)

Push/Pull/Legs · 2-Week Rotating Cycle

WEEK 1							
	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION	AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy	AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy	AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day	REST	AG4 Push Day 2 — Power	AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power	AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day 2 — Power
WARM UP	AG Push Day Warm Up	AG Pull Day Warm Up	AG Leg Day Warm Up	REST	1,000 Steps Stair Climber	AG Pull Day Warm Up	AG Leg Day Warm Up
ABS	Select from Abs Library	Back Extension — 3 × failure	Select from Abs Library	REST	Select from Abs Library	Back Extension — 3 × failure	Select from Abs Library
CARDIO	Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	REST	AG Power Cardio	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming

WEEK 2 — THEN REPEAT FROM WEEK 1							
	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION	AG4 Push Day 3 — Speed	AG Pull Day 3 — Biceps Focus	AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day	REST	AG4 Push Day 2 — Power	AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power	AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day 2 — Power
WARM UP	AG Push Day Warm Up	AG Pull Day Warm Up	AG Leg Day Warm Up	REST	1,000 Steps Stair Climber	AG Pull Day Warm Up	AG Leg Day Warm Up
ABS	Decline Sit Ups 2×fail Ab Roller 3×fail Speed Sit Ups 4×fail	Back Extension — 3 × failure	Select from Abs Library	REST	Select from Abs Library	Back Extension — 3 × failure	Select from Abs Library
CARDIO	AG Speed Cardio — sprints / speed movements	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	REST	AG Power Cardio	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming	HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming

* At the advanced level, apply 3–5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

This is essentially the superman programme for those that take the gym really seriously. If you are completing this, you will have an elite body in no time. This is a great programme to build muscle, aesthetics, and a functional body if you are off season from your sport.

Warm ups, the types of cardio, and the abs library will be explained in later pages. For now take a look at the timetable and visualise the programme.

How Many Days To Workout Per Week?

The objective is to workout 5 days a week.

If you workout 5 days a week this program will consist of PPL, PP. (Push Pull Legs, Push Pull.)

There is also room to do 4 days a week by removing a Lower Body Session to do Push Pull Legs and a Full Body workout to ensure each muscle group is hit a minimum of twice in a week. If you have a bad week and miss a few sessions, hitting a one push, one pull, one legs, and a Full body is enough to effectively work the entire body.

Finally if you wish to workout 6 days a week you can do a PPL PPL. This is two push days, two pull days and two legs days across the week with a days rest.

This programme has options, people think they want a “5 day a week programme” but the truth is, you’ll have weeks where you may end up doing 4 days or weeks where you want to do more days. This is why a programme that lets you breathe with options such as this programme is important. Learning how to drop off a day and which day to drop off is important.

Try to stick to 5 sessions as a baseline most of the time. And if you have a bad week where you only hit 4 sessions, try to make up for it by doing at least one full body session in that week.

Alternatively, I usually recommend missing a Leg day for male clients on a really inconsistent week, as males benefit from targeting their upper body more frequently for aesthetics. So on 4 days a week you could also do a Push Pull Push Pull type split.

If you know beforehand that you are going to be working out 3 days that week, check out my 3 day a week full body programme and run it for that week. Or just do one push pull and legs each from this 5 day programme and accept gains will come slightly slower that week.

Warm Ups

Pull Day Warm Up



Band Pull Aparts: Pull a resistance band apart at chest level. Keep your triceps locked out and don't bend at the elbows. Do one set overhand and one set underhand.

Scapular Pull Ups: Hang from a bar and shrug your shoulders down and back to elevate your body 1 - 3 inches upwards with arms totally straight.

Arm Circles: Hold your arms out to the side and then move them in circles. 15 seconds forwards and 15 seconds backwards. Increase the size of the circles as you go.

Push Day Warm Up

Band Pass Throughs: Pass the band behind your head and pass it slowly around your back, trying not to touch your back. You should pass the band to around chest height behind you, and pull it apart gently.

Do the movement slowly over the course of 5 seconds. Then bring it back. This works your stabiliser muscles and increases your shoulder mobility.

Band Pull Aparts: Pull a resistance band apart at chest level. Keep your triceps locked out and don't bend at the elbows. You can do this with dumbbells too, but due to the gravity and resistance a resistance band provides, it is better to use bands. Do one set overhand and one set underhand.

Arm Circles: Hold your arms out to the side and then move them in circles. 15 seconds forwards and 15 seconds backwards. Increase the size of the circles as you go.

Warm Ups

Leg Day Warm Up



5 Minute Warmup On Treadmill

Bodyweight Squats With Toe Taps:

After every squat lift your leg up to chest height and touch your right toe against your left hand. Then the next squat touch your left toe to your right hand. Bring your legs as high as flexibility allows.

Hold A Hip Flexor Stretch (A very deep leaning forward lunge where your back knee is 1 inch from the floor) for 15 seconds each Leg.

AG4 Push Day 1 (Hypertrophy)

Complete your AG4 Push Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Incline DB Press (nn) ▶

4 x 12

Shoulder DB Press ▶

4 x 10

Incline Bench or Smith (nn) ▶

3 x 12

Plate Loaded Incline Chest ▶

3 x 8

High To Low Cable Fly(nn) or DB Fly ▶

4 x 12

Dips (nn) ▶

4 x failure

Triceps Cable Pushdown x Triceps Behind Head

Cable Extension Superset (nn) ▶

3 x 12

Shoulder Press Machine Tri Set*

3 x 12

Lateral Raises AG Dropset* (nn)

ABS BLOCK

5 Minutes, Any Workout From Abs Exercise Library

CARDIO

Zone 5 (Hand Bike and Boxing Bag or Ski RG and Battle Ropes)

*nn = Non Negotiable. These exercises form the base of your Push Day and are possible with just a rack, a barbell and some dumbbells. The extra exercises that are not marked nn are for when you have energy for a big day in a well equipped gym.

*Check out the Advanced Training Techniques Library for the Shoulder Press Tri Set & Lateral Raises AG Tri Set.

AG4 Push Day 2 (Speed)

Complete your AG4 Push Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Incline DB Press (nn) ▶

3x12

Incline or Flat Bench Press (nn) ▶

3x12

Machine Chest Press ▶

3x15

Machine Chest Fly (nn) ▶

3x12

Shoulder Press Machine Tri - Set* ▶

3x12

Lateral Raises AG Dropset* (nn) x ▶

Cable Lateral Raises Superset

3x15, 3 x 8

ABS BLOCK

Abs: Decline Sit Ups With Plate Or Barbell ▶

2 x failure

Ab Roller ▶

3 x failure

Speed Sit Ups on Stability Ball or on Floor ▶

4 x failure

CARDIO

AG Speed Cardio Day ▶

*nn = Non Negotiable. These exercises form the base of your Push Day and are possible with just a rack, a barbell and some dumbbells. The extra exercises that are not marked nn are for when you have energy for a big day in a well equipped gym.

*Check out the Advanced Training Techniques Library for the Shoulder Press Tri Set & Lateral Raises AG Tri Set.

AG4 Push Day 3 (Power)

Warm Up: 1000 Steps Stair Climber or Jogging 3 Minutes

EXERCISES

Power Bench ▶

6 5 4 3 1

Power OHP ▶

5 5 5 3 3

Weighted Dips ▶

3x5

Machine Chest Press ▶

3x6

Heavy Lateral Raise ▶

3 x 6-8

Heavy Tricep Pushdown ▶

3x5

CARDIO

AG Power Cardio Day ▶

AG4 Pull Day 1

Complete Your Pull Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Pull ups (wide-normal-commando) (nn) ▶

3 x failure

Lat Pulldown(nn) ▶

4 x 15

Rear Delt Fly Machine (nn) ▶

4x12

AG Back Tri Set* (nn) ▶

3 Sets

Cable Row ▶

3x15

ABS BLOCK

Back Extension ▶

3x12

FINISHER:

**Static Pull Up holds 5seconds Bar to Forehead, 5
seconds Bar To Chin, 5 Seconds Dead Hang**

2 Bar Hangs until failure. (nn) ▶

CARDIO

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6

Rounds Punch Bag

***Check out the Advanced Training Systems section for a description of the
AG Back Tri Set.**

*nn = Non Negotiable. These exercises form the base of your Push Day and are possible with just a rack, a barbell and some dumbbells. The extra exercises that are not marked nn are for when you have energy for a big day in a well equipped gym.

AG4 Pull Day 2

Complete Your Pull Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Dumbbell Shrugs x Upright Row x Behind Back

Barbell Shrugs TRI SET (nn) ▶

4 x 12

Pull Ups (nn) ▶

3 x failure

Lat Pulldown ▶

3 x 15

Machine Row 3 x 12 OR T Bar Row (Power) (nn) ▶

3 x 5

Rear Delts Machine (nn) ▶

3 x 12

Rear Delts Cable Fly ▶

3 x 12

Cable Row ▶

3 x 15

Bicep Curl Machine or Bicep Curl (nn) ▶

4 x 12

Reverse DB Curls ▶

2 x 15

ABS BLOCK

Back Extension ▶

3x12

CARDIO

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6

Rounds Punch Bag

*nn = Non Negotiable. These exercises form the base of your Push Day and are possible with just a rack, a barbell and some dumbbells. The extra exercises that are not marked nn are for when you have energy for a big day in a well equipped gym.

AG4 Pull Day 3 (BICEPS FOCUSED)

Complete Your Pull Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Biceps Machine Curl or Kettlebell Bicep Curl (nn) ▶
4 x 12

Barbell Biceps Curl EZ Bar (Forced Reps With Partner or AG Military Dropset.) (nn) ▶
3 x 15

Incline Bench DB Curl x Concentration Curl Superset (nn) ▶
5 x 5

Hammer Curls Dropset (nn) ▶
3 x 12

DB Reverse Curls x Wrist Curls Superset ▶
3 x 15

Pull Ups (nn) ▶
3 x failure

Barbell Row ▶
3 x 15

Rear Delts Machine x DB Rear Delt Fly (nn) ▶
4 x failure

Face Pulls ▶
3 x 15

ABS BLOCK

Back Extension ▶
3x12

CARDIO

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6 Rounds Punch Bag

*Once every two weeks, hit a pull workout like this where you start with your biceps to focus more on the biceps muscle.

*Check the Advanced Training Systems section at the end of this programme for an understanding of Forced Reps and the AG Military Dropset.

AG4 Leg + Shoulders Day 1 (Hypertrophy)

Complete Your Leg Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Barbell Shoulder Press ▶

3 x 12 slow negatives

Lateral Raises AG Superset + Static Holds* ▶

2 x 15

Arnold Press ▶

2 x 12

Squats Reverse Pyramid ▶

12 10 8 6

Leg Destroyer* ▶

3 Circuits

Leg Curl Machine ▶

3x12

Standing or Seating Calves Machine ▶

3x12

ABS BLOCK

Any Exercise From The Abs Library

CARDIO

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6

Rounds Punch Bag

*Check the Advanced Training Systems section at the end of this programme for an understanding of the Lateral Raises AG Superset & Leg Destroyer.

AG4 Leg + Shoulders Day 2 (Power)

Complete Your Leg Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Barbell Shoulder Press ▶

4 x 5 Slow Negatives

Lateral Raises AG Superset + Static Holds* ▶

2 x 15

Arnold Press or Shoulder Press Machine ▶

3 x 12

Squats Reverse Pyramid ▶

12 10 8 6

Leg Extension Machine ▶

4 x 12

Hip Thrust Machine ▶

3x12

RDL ▶

3x12

Standing Or Seated Calves Machine ▶

4 x 12

ABS BLOCK

Any Exercise From The Abs Library

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6

Rounds Punch Bag

CARDIO

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6

Rounds Punch Bag

*Check the Advanced Training Systems section at the end of this programme for an understanding of the Lateral Raises AG Superset.

Advanced Training Techniques

You will notice on your programme card that it mentions applying 3 – 5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per workout session.

Here are the advanced training techniques:

General Techniques:

Drop Sets

On your final set of a marked exercise, instead of stopping when you hit failure, immediately reduce the weight by around 20-30% and keep going. Drop the weight again and repeat for 3 drops total. Aim for 8-10 reps at each drop. You will see a small reduction in reps each time – this is completely normal. This month, look out for the green tick marker on specific exercises and apply this technique to your last set only.

Partial Reps

Partial reps are performed in the lower 25% of the range of motion: short, controlled pulses that maintain constant tension in the muscle. They are used at the end of a set, when full reps are no longer possible, to maximize muscle fatigue. After reaching muscle failure, perform 3 to 5 partial reps before lowering the weight. You can also perform partial reps with each rep of your set, doing 3 partial reps for every repetition.

Try both methods often!

Pause Reps

Pause reps involve holding the weight completely still at the most difficult part of the movement—usually at the bottom—for 3 to 4 seconds before continuing. This eliminates momentum, forcing the muscle to work under pure tension. Include a 4-second pause on every repetition. Use a slightly lighter weight than usual to compensate for the increased difficulty.

Slow Reps

Slow repetitions involve controlling each phase of the movement with a tempo of 4 seconds on the lift and 4 seconds on the lowering of the weight. Think: 4 seconds up and 4 seconds down. This method increases time under tension, improves muscle control, and makes the muscle work harder during each repetition. Use this technique on every repetition. Slightly reduce the weight to maintain proper technique and controlled movement throughout the set.

Pre-Exhaust

Pre-Exhaust involves performing an isolation exercise immediately before a compound movement with no rest in between. This fatigues the target muscle first, ensuring it reaches maximum exhaustion during the compound exercise instead of letting other muscles do more work. A classic example is doing leg extensions before squats—your quads will already be burning when you start squatting, forcing the muscle to work harder. There is also Dumbbell Flys before Dumbbell Chest Press, or Lateral Raises before Dumbbell Shoulder Press.

Post-Exhaust

Post-exhaustion is the reverse of pre-exhaustion. You hit the compound movement first to recruit maximum muscle fibres, then immediately follow it with an isolation exercise to finish off the target muscle completely with no rest in between sets. For example, Leg press followed immediately by Leg Extensions ensures the quads are fully worked even after the glutes and hamstrings have taken some of the load in the compound.

Myo Reps

Myo-reps are a training method where you take a set close to failure, then rest for about 5–10 seconds and do 5 more reps. After that, you rest again for 5–10 seconds and do another 5 reps. You repeat this cycle around 3 times, or until you can't keep the reps clean anymore. You can use this technique on your last set of an exercise or every set, experiment with what works for you.

Pyramid Training

Pyramid training means adjusting your weight and reps across 4 sets in a structured pattern. An ascending pyramid starts lighter with higher reps and builds to heavier weight with lower reps — great for warming into a heavy movement safely. A descending pyramid starts heavy and works back down — good for pushing strength early when you are freshest. Rep schemes for upward pyramid: 6 8 10 12. Rep schemes for downward pyramid 12 10 8 6. Squats are a great exercise for this type of training.

Run The Rack

The Run The Rack technique is where you finish your last set, and then keep pulling out the pin and switching to the next lowest weight and you continue doing repetitions without rest, and then every time you fatigue you pull out the pin and go one weight lower until you reach a weight of 0. You can do this on machines by pulling out the pin and setting a lower weight each time, or on the dumbbell rack by picking up a lighter pair of dumbbells until you reach the lowest weight on the dumbbell rack.

Tri Sets

Tri Sets chain three exercises together with no rest between any of them — only the time it takes to move between stations. This is one of the most intense techniques in the library. The idea is to keep switching to a slightly easier exercise as you fatigue, meaning the muscle stays under tension for far longer than a normal set. Hit each exercise to failure and move straight to the next. Only rest once all exercises in the Tri-Set are complete.

Forced Reps

This is where you take your set until failure, and then get your partner to continue to assist you by putting pressure on the barbells, dumbbells, or machines in order to help you continue doing more repetitions. Aim for 5 extra repetitions at the end of each set after failure with the help of your partner.

Heavy Eccentrics

This is where you take 120% of your 1 rep max. Yes, 120% of your 1 rep max. This is very heavy and this technique should not be used often. Load it onto a Barbell for a Bicep Curl, and get your partner to assist you with the concentric (lifting the barbell to your chest) and then you carry out the eccentric portion of the movement (lowering the bar) unassisted and try to do slow 4 second declines. Aim for 5 repetitions for 3 sets.

This will shock and grow the muscles very heavily at this weight and intensity.

Push Day Advanced Training Techniques

AG Lateral Raises Dropset

Do 15 repetitions of Lateral Raises, then pick up a lighter dumbbell and do 15 more repetitions without resting. Then take a minutes rest. Do this Dropset 3 times in total.

Triceps Buster

This is a mega set including multiple different exercises with no rest. Triceps Cable Pushdown 3 x 15 reps into 3 x 15 Behind Head Cable Extensions. Into 3 x 15 Bench Dips and finally 3 x 15 Single Arm Dumbbell Extension. Beginners can start with the first two exercises as a superset (the cable pushdowns into extensions with no rest), and then graduate to the full mega set once they build strength.

Shoulder Press Machine Tri – Set

Do a set on the Shoulder Press Machine, and directly after with no rest pick up a weight plate and do Front Raises. After the Front Raises, do Upright Row with a Barbell or the same plate without rest.

Shoulder Press Machine 12 Reps into
Plate Front Raises 15 Reps into
Plate or Barbell Upright Row 10 Reps

Pull Day Advanced Training Techniques

AG Military Dropset

I learned this from a military man in the gym. Take an EZ bar and do 15 repetitions. After this, drop off some weight plates, try to remove about **50%** of the weight from the bar, take no rest and do another 15 repetitions. Do 3 sets of this.

Try and load the bar with **smaller** plates to make it easier to drop the weight by 50% each time. For example set 1 could be 10kg with a bunch of 2.5kg plates, and then set 2 you would drop off a plate from **each side**, leaving the weight on each side halved and weighing 5kg.

AG Back Tri Set

Barbell Row x 12
T – Bar Row x 15
One Arm Dumbbell Row x 12

This is a **time saving technique** I use on back day.

Position yourself in a rack. Start with a Barbell Row. Hit 10 – 12 reps on this exercise.

Then pick up one side only of the same barbell and use it as a T – Bar row.

As you are only lifting one half of the barbell, this drops the weight by approximately 50%, you can do **more** repetitions than before. Therefore, hit 15 repetitions of this exercise.

Then take a **dumbbell** that you keep nearby, and use the nearby surface of the rack to rest your hands against, and perform one-arm dumbbell rows for 12 reps each arm. This is a really fast way to hit **3 different** back exercises rapidly on a busy day in the gym, and all you need to do is to stay within **1 rack**.

As an **alternative** to this technique, you can also do a Standing Barbell Row, straight into a Standing Dumbbell Row, straight into an Inverse Bodyweight Row on a barbell racked in a rack, at about chest height, with your knees bent for a lower and more challenging angle.

Forearm Finisher

Do Barbell Reverse Curls, and then pick up a lighter barbell and do Wrist Curls forwards and backwards whilst holding the weight out in front of you.

Do one single Wrist Curl forwards and then one backwards, and do this repeatedly until it burns and you fail. Do 3 sets of the Reverse Curls into the Wrist Curls.

Push Day Advanced Training Techniques

Leg Destroyer

Leg Press 12 reps
6 Walking Dumbbell Lunges each Leg walk over to the:
Leg Extension Machine 15 reps
456
Go between these machines 3 times.

20 Reps Of Pain

1 set of 20 reps on the Hack Squat machine. Even with no weight added to the machine, this is a hard challenge to finish. Or more sets if you are brave enough...

Calves Destroyer

Machine 1: Seated Calve Raise Machine
2: Standing Calve Raise Machine
3: 45 Degree Leg Press Calve Raises
4: Free weight Exercise: Standing Dumbbell Calve Raises

If your gym allows for it, hit all these machines **one after the other!** You don't even have to do more than one or two sets of each, as long as you squeeze the rep for 4 seconds at the top of the movement, and go slowly back down, the burn will add up by the end.

Aim to go to failure at around the 15th rep in each set.

Abs Library

You can learn and pick a variety of ab workouts from this library. This stops you getting bored and gives you the choice to workout how you want when it comes to your abs. The variety also helps your abs to grow by challenging them in different ways rather than doing the same workout all the time. You will feel each workout hit your abs slightly differently.

Abs 1 (Hypertrophy)

5 Minutes of Roman Chair Sit Ups
Or
Abs Machine 3 Sets Of 20

Abs 2 (AG Speed Abs)

4 Sets Of 50 Crunches As Fast As You Can

Advanced circuit version of Abs 2:
Decline Sit Ups x failure
Ab Wheel Rollout x failure
Speed Sit Ups As Fast As You Can x failure
(3 rounds of circuit)

Abs 3 (Bodyweight)

3 sets of 12 Leg Raises
5 L Sit attempts

Abs 4 (Hypertrophy)

Decline Sit Ups with a weight plate until failure
Into Ab Wheel Rollouts until failure
Into Fitness Ball Sit Ups until failure Perform 3 rounds.

Abs 5

Hanging Leg Raises 3 Sets Of 12
Ab Wheel Rollouts 3 Sets Of 12

Abs 6 (Explosive)

Decline Sit Ups (Explosively Pushing
A Barbell Into The Sky) 3 Sets Of 12

Captains Chairs Leg Raises With A Dumbbell
On Your Feet (until failure)

Go as fast as you can on the Captains Chair Leg Raises, do 5 repetitions and then try to launch the dumbbell out of your feet as far as you can each time. Then keep going with the leg raises until failure. Picture each repetition as though you are trying to launch the dumbbell as far as you can.

Abs 7 (Burnout)

Roman Chair Sit Ups 3 x failure
Stability Ball Sit Ups 3 x failure
Medicine Ball V Ups 1 x failure
Decline Sit Ups With BarBell Explosive 3 x failure
Abdominal Curl Machine 3 x 12

Abs 8 (High Reps - Lots Of Growth)

This is a challenging circuit that burns, but it adds size to abs very fast.

Leg Raises 30s
Flutter Kicks 30s
Planks 30s
Plank Ups 30s
(3 Rounds - 6 Minutes Total With No Rest)

Abs 9 (Time Under Tension Circuit)

Arnold's Abs Giant Set:

Hanging Straight Leg Raises – 20 reps

Hanging Knee Ups – 20 reps

Crunches – 50 reps

Seated Leg Tucks – 30 reps

Stick Twist – 100 reps

Do not take rest in this set!

Within the AG4 system, you can also do 5 minutes of Abs work from the “6 Pack Shortcuts” accelerator programme found in the programs section. This programme will show you how to progress your abdominal exercises to advanced levels, ensuring you are making your abdominal workouts more difficult each week instead of staying at the same intensity.

Types Of Cardio Explained

In this programme you will notice a few types of cardio on your programme card.

Zone 2 Cardio

This is steady state exercise. To put simply you exercise at around a 6/10 intensity, so a light jog or light use of other cardio machines. This keeps your heart rate in "Zone 2" which is 60 – 70% of your maximum.

Punch Bag

Buy some gloves and do 30 minutes of exercise on a punch bag, learning combos and technique.

HIIT

Do a HIIT workout. You can find these on Youtube or also check out the HIIT workout provided below. For a workout to be HIIT you have to spend at least 10 minutes working at near maximum heart rate, (near 9 / 10 intensity.)

HIIT Workout

HIIT Workout

30s High Knees
30s Burpees
30s Squat Taps
30s Plyo Lunges
30s Mountain Climbers
30s Squat Jumps
30s Jumping Jacks
30s Kettlebell Swings
30s Med Ball Slams
30s Plank Jacks
(2 rounds)

Make sure you go to max effort on each exercise to make up a minimum of 10 minutes max effort. If you wish to workout for 30 minutes, you can spend 20 minutes after doing some light cardio or jogging, but ensure you do 10 minutes of max effort first.



Click to watch workout video

Speed Cardio

This programme has cardio days that will help you to become a better athlete should you play sports or partake in exercise classes.

Speed is one of the attributes we work on in this programme in order to make you a better athlete.

Speed is about moving fast and performing an exercise as fast as you can.

Beginners Speed Cardio Workout

5 speed squats
30s light high knees (active rest) (Repeat this combination 5 times and move on)
5 speed burpees
30second skipping on the spot (Repeat this combination 2 times and then move on)
5 speed left hand punches
5 speed right hand punches
30 seconds marching on the spot (Repeat combination 3 times and move on)
Shadowboxing Fast Punch Flurries 5 seconds 30 seconds light high knees
(Repeat this combination 3 times then finish)



Click to watch workout video

Speed Cardio

Advanced Speed Cardio Workout

This is for the more serious athlete, requiring a gym environment and more equipment.

5 speed squats
30s light high knees (active rest) (Repeat this combination 5 times and move on)
5 speed burpees
30second skipping on the spot (Repeat this combination 2 times and then move on)
5 speed left hand punches
5 speed right hand punches
30 seconds marching on the spot (Repeat combination 3 times and move on)
5 reps plyo push ups
30 seconds light skipping on spot (repeat combination 2 times and move on)
Shadowboxing Punch Flurries 5 seconds 30 seconds light high knees (Repeat this combination 3 times and move on)
5 Light Med Ball Slams 20seconds light skipping on spot 30s (Repeat this combination 3 times and move on)
Light Sled Pushes (load 10 – 25% of bodyweight) x 5 sets



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Speed Cardio

Advanced Speed Cardio Workout (Continued)

Optional (Agility Ladder Drills x5sets with 30 second active rest)

Single Leg

Double Leg

In In Out Out

2 Foot In 2 Foot Out Hops

Ali shuffles.

The sled pushes are scientifically proven to improve sprint speed. The speed punches will increase your punching speed for sports such as boxing. The agility ladder will increase your foot speed, and the jump squats will increase your jump speed for sports such as basketball.

You can also replace your Speed Cardio day with x10 max effort 15 second Sprints on a Treadmill or outside, as getting faster at sprints is also a part of Speed Training.



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Power Cardio

Power cardio is training for explosive Power. Training for Power is similar to training for Speed, we try to lift very fast. However, when we train for speed we lift as fast as we can with no resistance (weights) to slow us down. Training for Explosive Power means we lift as fast as we can but against load (WITH moderate weights.)

This training style builds our ability to move fast and powerfully under load, it means we achieve more in sports, and get a certain “look” about us of not just being big, but being powerful and capable. Explosive power is more than just moving fast with no weights, but being able to move fast when weights are added to the equation.



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Power Cardio

Power Cardio Workout

Warm Up:

**Bodyweight Pogo Jumps 15 Reps Each Stance (Left Foot Forward +
Right Foot Forward)
Flying Knees 15 Reps Each Stance**

Workout:

**Med Ball Knees x 6 Reps Each Knee
Dumbbell Pogo Jumps x 6 Reps Left Foot Forward
Dumbbell Pogo Jumps x 6 Reps Right Foot Forward
Med Ball Rotational Slams x 6 Reps Each Side
Decline Plank Leg Ups 8-10 Reps Per Leg
Med Ball Uppercuts 10 Reps Each Stance
Kettlebell Rotational Swings 14 - 20 Reps
Kneeling Squat Jumps x 6 Reps
Plyometric Lunges 6 Reps Per Leg
One Arm Dumbbell Press 8 Reps Per Arm**



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Zone 5 Cardio

The most intense form of cardio. This goes beyond just high intensity (9/10.) This is max effort, which means the workout is only 10 minutes long if that. Max effort means you cannot possibly be working harder, and when you finish the workout you should be at the point where another repetition is impossible to sustain. The type of cardio where you couldn't possibly continue doing more after.

We have assigned this to once a week, but due to it's intense nature, it is always optional and replaceable with some Zone q or another cardio form of your choice.

However if you are not feeling burned out, it is great to push yourself in this zone.

Examples Of Zone 5

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
45 seconds **active rest** (pedalling slowly)

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
Ski RG 45 seconds **active rest**

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
Punch Bag 45 Seconds Jab Cross Hook Hard As You Can

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Ski RG 15seconds max effort
Punch Bag 45 Seconds Jab Cross Hook Hard As You Can

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
Ski RG 45 seconds **active rest**

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Assault Bike 15seconds max effort
Punch Bag 45 Seconds Jab Cross Hook Hard As You Can

Set Timer for 10 – 15 minutes straight and repeat this cycle.

Further Cardio To Experiment With

For variety, I have included some more types of cardio to try on occasion, instead of the usual Zone 2 steady state cardio, feel free to incorporate cardio fitness into your life in whatever way inspires your love for fitness. Do sports, exercise classes, Youtube workouts, find the styles of cardio that work for you.

Interval Training

Pick a cardio machine or even two to switch between if you wish. Interval training is where you cycle between an easy (rest interval) and hard effort (work interval). To make learning this process as easy as possible,, we will rest for 30 seconds at an intensitiy of 4 out of 10 and then work for an effort of 7 out of 10 for 30 seconds. Keeping it 30 and 30 makes things simple and easy to time.

Depending on your sport, interval times may change as some sports require longer or shorter work rest periods, but this is just a basic introduction. Intervals will push you slightly harder than a same speed Zone 2 run that you have been using for your cardio in the beginner programs. This results in your cardio improving. You become better at short bursts of exercise and become fitter at more intense exercise, which is important for your overall health.

Sprints

Sprints release a great amount of hormones which allow us to build more muscle. They hit a different energy system to long distance running and it is beneficial for our heart lungs and general health to be fit in this way too. This month, lets incorporate 10 sprints into our cardio, whether outside or on the treadmill.

10 x 15seconds Maximum Speed Sprints if outside
10 x 25seconds Maximum Speed Sprints if on Treadmill

(We give 10 seconds extra for the Treadmill to bring us up to our maximum speed as treadmills delay in working up to full speed..)

Fartlek Training

This is free flowing training where you bring yourself up to 7 out of 10 effort, and then ease off slightly back down to a 5, then bring yourself back up to a 7-8 again multiple times in a workout. You don't time yourself or use intervals or any kind of plan, you push yourself based off of feeling alone.

Experiment with bringing yourself to a 7-8 intensity and back down to a 5 multiple times in a 20-30 minute period. You can do this with any type of cardio machine or with a partner that pushes you on the boxing pads alternating between intense and light rounds.

Long Distance Runs

This month, I want you to try to jog a 5k distance once per week. This is a longer run, pace yourself accordingly and go as slow as necessary to finish the distance. You can walk / jog in alternation to complete the distance. Work up to 10ks and hour long runs. If you already run long distance, just go for your usual long run for the week.

Metabolic Circuits

Metabolic circuits burn calories and build muscle at the same time. It is cardio with the explosive use of light to moderate weights that accomplishes this.

These movements burn more calories than normal Zone 2 cardio. Essentially you burn more calories per hour which is good for your fat loss, but also you get the added benefits of extra muscle because you are doing light and explosive forms of weightlifting as you do your cardio. This is a very productive and time efficient way of doing cardio.

See the example kettlebell workout on the next page.



Click to watch workout video

Kettlebell Cardio Workout

Round 1:

Kettlebell Swings 30s
Kettlebell Snatches 30s
Double KB 5 burpee → snatch → clean
40 m heavy farmer carry

Round 2:

Russian Twists 30s
Kettlebell Mountain Climbers 30s
Kettlebell Squat Into Head Halo 30s
40m heavy farmer carry

Round 3:

Kettlebell Thruster 30s
Kettlebell Swings 30s
Kettlebell Deadlift Into Press Up x5
40m heavy farmer carry

Beginner: 1 repeat of full workout.

Intermediate: 2 repeats of full workout.

Advanced: 3 repeats of full workout.



[Click to watch workout video](#)

Battle Ropes

Battle ropes improve your cardio whilst building shoulder and core muscles.

Warm Up:

1kg Dumbbell Shoulder Presses +

1kg Explosive Dumbbell Shoulder Push Outs

(Push the Dumbbells straight out in front of you, and back to your chest, then push them straight up overhead and back to your shoulders, repeat these two exercises in a fast pumping motion for 1 minute.)

Workout:

Battle Rope Alternating Waves (Singles) (20s)

40s Active Rest

Battle Rope Waves (Doubles) (20s)

40s Active Rest

Battle Rope Slams (20s)

40s Active Rest

Battle Rope Star Jumps (20s)

40s Active Rest

Burpees into Battle Rope Slams (20s)

Active Rest Options:

Choose one of the following during each 40-second recovery period:

Step-Ups

High Knees

Russian Twists

Mountain Climbers

Duration:

Beginner: 1 Round

Intermediate: 2 Rounds

Advanced: 3 Rounds

Cool Down:

5 – 10 Minutes Treadmill



Click to watch workout video

Easy Days

I want to introduce the concept of easy days. We all have jobs. We all have times where we probably won't go to the gym unless it's made to be a simple choice for us. We all have times where our bodies are simply tired. In these situations, you can implement easy days.

These are 30 minute days designed to just get you in the gym to be consistent, they will still grow you, but they are only 4 exercises as not to be intimidating workouts that you have to "figure out" from a long listed timetable.

They are just quick simple days to build into your muscle memory, go in and use these days often when you feel drained. A 30 minute quick and effective workout is better than no workout in nearly all cases despite severe injury, or if you ran a marathon the day before, this fact remains true.

Push Easy Day:

DB Incline Chest Press 3 x 12
DB Incline Shoulder Press 3 x 12
DB Lateral Raise 3 x 15
Triceps Extension 3 x 15

Pull Easy Day:

Pull Ups 3 x 12
Barbell Row 3 x 12
Rear Delt Fly Machine 3 x 12
Biceps Curl 3 x 12

Legs Easy Day:

Leg Press Machine 3 x 12
Leg Extension Machine 3 x 12
Lying Leg Curl Machine 3 x 12

Equipment Substitutions

On Push Day, depending on if you have more access to a lot of heavy weights that will challenge you in dumbbells or if you have access to heavy weights on the bench press, you will do that exercise first.

This program is heavily focused on improving your Dumbbell Incline Bench Press to develop your Upper Chest shelf aesthetics. However, let's say in a well equipped gym usually you can do 30kg dumbbells, but in your current location the dumbbells do not go that high, and you have access to a Bench Press, do the Bench Press first and heavy on your Push Day and the Dumbbells after.

If you have no access to heavy weights on your Bench Press, but have heavier dumbbells, then do the Incline Dumbbell Press first and the Bench after. Always ensure progressive overload and progression on at least one of these exercises every session (barbell or dumbbell chest press.) based on the most effective weights you have.

It is ideal to be consistent in terms of equipment wherever possible and go through consistent periods of working on one of these forms of chest press over the other if you really want to see a specific lift progress, but this is the protocol for when equipment conditions are less favorable.

Strategic substitutions also include doing Dumbbell Flys instead of Cable Flys or Chest Fly Machine if you are not in a well equipped gym.

Resistance Bands can be used for Triceps Pushdowns And Triceps Overhead Extensions.

Equipment Substitutions

On Leg Day, if you have absolutely no equipment to chose from, then Pistol Squat and assisted Pistol Squat practice is a valuable alternative. Multiple sets of this can grow your Leg muscles with limited equipment.

Nordic Hamstring Curls are also effective if you have some kind of mat to protect your knees. The Nordic Hamstring curls supersetted with Slow Bulgarian Split Squats with a 3 second Pause at the bottom. Even better if you can find some kind of 5kg weight or add weight to a Rucksack to hold, and do Single Leg RDL's with a 3 second Pause at the bottom and your Bulgarian Split Squats with the weight too.

Finally, your Squat Burnouts will include Wall Sits in the bottom of a Squat for 45 seconds and then go straight into 21s (7 lower half squats, 7 upper half squats, and then 7 full squats) for 3 total circuits can burn out your legs.

This can keep you growing in an environment where a well equipped gym is not accessible, however a well equipped gym would always be my first choice for the fastest growth.

Pull Day Substitutions - If you do not have access to a Rear Delt Fly Machine, you can perform a superset consisting of Dumbbell Rear Delt Fly and Resistance Band Face Pulls for 3 sets of 15 each.

Barbells can always be substituted for Dumbbells or Kettlebells for Bicep Curls.

Equipment Modifications

This programme is designed around training at a well equipped gym, however here are some common modifications you can make if faced with limitations around specific exercises.

Barbell Exercises – Exercises such as the Barbell Row, Barbell Bicep Curl can be replaced by Dumbbell variations of those exercises.

Dumbbell Exercises – Exercises such as the Dumbbell Shoulder Press and Incline Dumbbell Bench Press can be replaced by Barbell variations of those exercises.

Assisted Pull Up Machine – The first point of call would be to use a heavy resistance band. Use a step or box to give yourself the height required to step into the band, this will help you to do pull ups.

However if this is too challenging, using a bar in a squat rack, set at chest height, can allow you to do Floor assisted Pull Ups where your buttocks and feet touch the floor with your knees bent at the start of every repetition. You can produce the same motion as a pull up. Finally, simply using a bench, a box or another stable raised surface underneath a pull up bar can help you to do Pull Ups. Keep your legs on the raised surface and use them to help you do the pull up by straightening your legs on the way up, and bending your knees on the way down. Select the option that works best for your skill level.

Rear Delt Machine – The Dumbbell Rear Delt Fly can be used as a replacement for this machine. I find the machine smoother and allows me to push to a greater intensity than dumbbells, so to match this without the machine I would use a Superset of Rear Delt Dumbbell Flys (15 reps) straight into Resistance Band Face Pulls (15 reps). This is a solid alternative to work your Rear Delts.

Lateral Pulldown – Hooking a resistance band to a surface above can act as a Lateral Pulldown. Simply doing a Band Pull Apart with a resistance band starting from over your head can also act as a Lateral Pulldown.

Triceps Pushdown / Triceps Behind The Head Extension – Instead of Cables, Resistance Bands attached to an overhead surface such as bar or Squat Rack, make for an excellent alternative for these exercises.

Barbell Squats – Dumbbell Squats or the Leg Press Machine is always an option to replace this exercise.

Calve Raise Machine – In the absence of a Calve Raise Machine, use Bodyweight Calve Raises or Dumbbell Calve Raises on a raised surface such as a step up box can help. Use heavy dumbbells and perform Single Leg Calve Raises to make the exercise more challenging.

Deloads

Every 8 weeks take a week where you reduce all set numbers and weights by 50%. Do not see this as a loss of momentum. This is so you can come back the next week harder and refreshed, reducing chances of injury and fatigue. Your lifts should feel fresh as you come back into lifting after the deload week. Don't use them all the time, you still have to workout consistently, but every 8 weeks is an effective use of deloads.

nded Pull Ups, Pull Up Negatives and Holds for Pull Up Plateaus.

How To Break A Plateau

Plateaus happen when you stop being able to add a repetition each week, you stop being able to PR (personal record.)

I suggest applying advanced training techniques on your isolation exercises to shock your muscles weekly. Adding extra sets each week can also help, so if you can't go up in weight, add a few more extra repetitions in 1 additional set. Adding an extra "Heavy day" to the gym where you go in and hit heavier than usual repetitions of an exercise in the 5 repetition range for 4 sets can also help. Finally, if the plateau is really bad, perform assistance exercises which are exercises that will specifically get you stronger on the exercise you are struggling with.

For example:

- **Weighted Dips and Close Grip Bench Press to improve the Bench Press.**
- **Lateral Pulldown, Band Assisted Pull Ups and Pull Up Negatives and Holds to improve Pull Ups.**
- **Farmer Carries, Bar Hangs, Back Extensions and RDL's for Deadlifts.**
- **Paused Squats, DEEP Hack Squats with a Pause, and DEEP Leg Press with a Pause for Squat plateau.**

Training For Life

After coming to the end of your year on this programme, you should have gained:

- A solid grasp of how to balance training with physical and mental recovery, knowing when to apply your easy days, and when to go hard.
- An understanding of how to build your body on good programming through advanced bodybuilding and cardio training techniques.
- You should have an idea of the exercises, supersets and “advanced training techniques” that work best for you, and how to break plateaus with heavy days and assistance exercises.

At This Stage You Have Two Options:

Option 1: Continue on this 5 day advanced programme, which is good for periods where you want to work hard to achieve fast growth.

Option 2: Reduce to a 3 or 4 day a week programme, or implement more easy days on this current programme. This option is good if life gets busy, you wish to relax your training, or you have built the body you wanted and just want to maintain it.

You'll find in life that you can't go hard forever. You will wish to train at different intensities at different stages in your life, following periods of hard work and faster growth with periods of relaxed work and slower growth.

When you have built your dream body, it doesn't take as much work or frequency to maintain muscle as it does to build it, so you may wish to drop down to lower amounts of sessions and time in the gym once you build the body you desire.

This makes it easy to work on your body for life. Whether you wish to train for 5 days a week, or cut back to 3 or 4, you have the tools to craft an amazing body.

Read This After Programme Completion

Building From AG – Use AG As A Base

The AG programmes are your base, you can experiment and add your own exercises here and there and make substitutions to find what you enjoy. You can strip things back and make sessions less intense or more intense.

The reason we design year round programmes at AG instead of 16 week programmes like everyone else is because we want to develop consistent programming into your muscle memory and really build techniques over the course of an entire year.

Doing these routines consistently for a whole year makes them stick in your head more and creates a lifestyle around a single routine with no sudden changes like on other programmes.

You Are Now Self Sufficient

You are now self-sufficient with your AG training programmes, which is what we wanted to build within every one of our members.

You could walk into any gym and perform these programmes confidently, knowing how to dial things back on a difficult day and how to push harder when you have more to give. This is something that can be taught through a year of repetition and gradual learning, but it cannot truly be learned in 16 weeks.

You should be proud because you have taken a whole year to learn different advanced techniques month by month, whilst sticking to the same template that you now know off by heart. You know how to expand this template and make it more challenging, and you also know how to make it easier when you need to.

You have built something much more valuable than just a year of workouts. You have learned how to train.

Make Fitness Your Own

At this stage, the world of fitness is yours.

You now have a base of different programmes with options for multiple days per week. Now is the time to keep learning and make these programmes your own if you wish.

Keep the foundation you have used to build your dream body: good programming, progressive training, consistency and the knowledge you have developed over the past year. From there, you can tweak that foundation to make training more fun, target any small weaknesses you feel you have, or help you learn new skills and sports.

There is always something new to learn. Keep educating yourself about fitness, bodybuilding, dieting, flexibility and mobility. There is always something you can improve, and that is part of what makes fitness so rewarding.

You Are The Hero

We wanted to teach you self sufficiency and also teach you to build fitness as a love and passion in your life. A lifestyle that you enjoy by making decisions for yourself too.

Coaching is great, we can all do with coaching! But we also want you to be strong and confident on your own too. We want you to eventually reach a point where you feel confident to take charge and build a great fitness lifestyle for yourself and have coaching as a complement to that, rather than being a person who feels like they couldn't live life without a coach.

The coach isn't the star here, you are the hero. You always have been. You make the decisions, and a coach just facilitates that.

Through our coaching we wanted people to actually see and realise that they aren't "nothing" without a coach, and that they don't need to be over reliant on coaching. We actually wanted people to become their own coaches first and foremost, and learn to use external coaching as a complement to their lives.

After all, it was you that arranged for, paid for, and followed the programme, you arranged for exercises to be swapped if you didn't like them, and selected your programme around the time you had available. It was all 80% you and 20% us. Therefore, go forward and take steps to experiment and build out your perfect routine, find ways to make fitness enjoyable for life, and work with coaching if you wish as a way to complement that.

Hit your protein, eat clean, and continue to learn about fitness, bodybuilding, dieting and flexibility and mobility. Healthy living is for life. There is always something to improve. All the best with your training!

- **Coach Tommy**

